

Extracting and composing alert fields

- Release version: Australia
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- Updated March 12, 2026
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- ⌚ 4 minutes to read

Extracting and composing are ways to manage what you see in the alert output, making it simpler to filter, group, and read. Alert automation enables you to extract values from event payload's alert field and place it in an alert output field. Composing allows you to merge multiple alert fields into a single output field.

Extracting alert fields

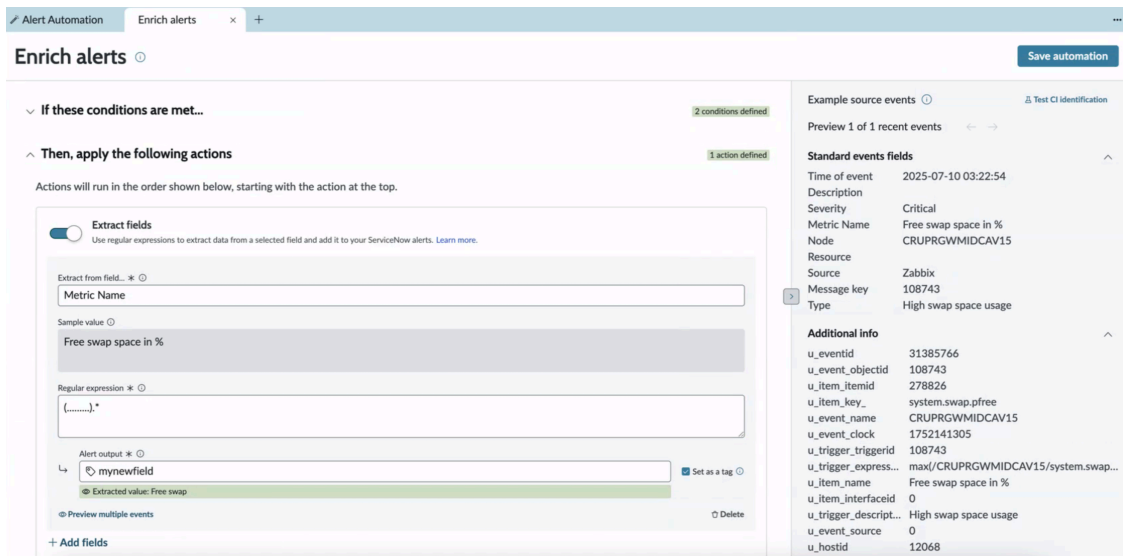
Alert notifications often contain relevant context buried within event payloads. By enriching alert outputs with values from the existing payload, you can better understand the significance of alerts and determine the appropriate steps for resolution. For example, a host name typically includes crucial information such as service, node, cluster, datacenter, and domain. To automatically add the value for a cluster tag based on incoming host data, you can extract just the cluster data.

When extracting alert fields, use regular expressions (regex) to build value formulas. Regex allows you to precisely identify and capture the relevant portions of the payload, enabling the creation of meaningful and actionable alert notifications.

Note:

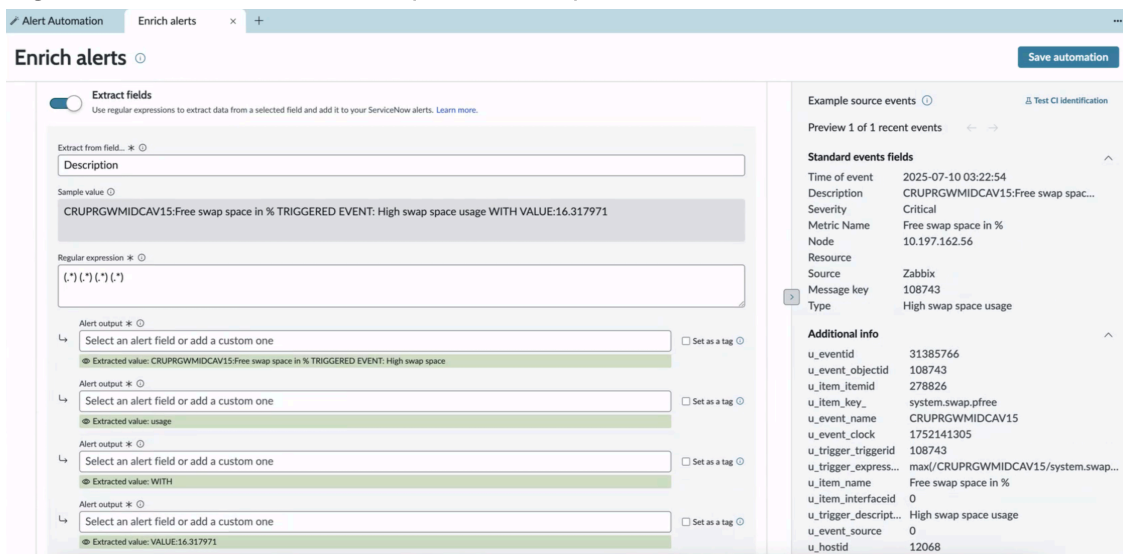
You can compose text using regular expression (regex) format conventions. Use one or more capture groups with parentheses to extract parts of the input. Capture groups in the regular expression are assigned to alert outputs based on the order in which they appear. The regex must match the entire input, so consider surrounding your regex with `.*` on each end. For example, `(\w+).acme.com.*` captures the host name in a fully qualified domain name. The parser for the regex engine is Perl Compatible Regular Expressions (PCRE) compatible.

Figure 1. Extract alert fields



If you use multiple capture groups with parentheses, each extracted value appears in a separate output field.

Figure 2. Extract field for multiple alert outputs



Preview the alert output across example events to verify that the values are extracted as expected by selecting Preview multiple events.

Note:

This option is available only when example source events are available and matched with the regex filter.

Example: Extracting alert fields

Suppose you need to extract only six letters from a specific field of an event and display them in a new alert field named `mynewfield`. You also want to tag this new alert field for later use in alert grouping. Here's how you can achieve this:

- Source input field: Select the event field from which you want to extract data. In this case, the field is Metric Name.

- Regular expression: Use a regular expression to extract the specific part you need from the selected field's value. For example, if the Metric Name field value contains "Free swap space in %" and you want to extract "Free swap", your regular expression must be `(.....)*.`
- Alert output:
 - Choose an existing alert field, an existing alert tag, or manually enter a new field name. In this case, let's enter a new field name `mynewfield`.
 - Set `mynewfield` as a tag for later use in tag-based grouping. Notice the tag displayed before the field name.

After applying the regular expression to the selected field's value (in this case the Metric Name field value), verify the extracted word displayed below the Alert output field. For instance, it should show "Free swap" if the regular expression matches correctly.

- Preview multiple events: Previewing multiple events allows you to verify if the regular expression accurately extracts data from a range of example events. This helps determine if any adjustments to the regular expression are needed.

Composing alert fields

When creating an alert output, you can select or manually enter fields, tags, or free text to include. This data can be easily read, filtered, and grouped for better management and understanding of the alerts.

Figure 3. Compose alert fields

Alert Automation Enrich alerts × +

Enrich alerts ⓘ Save automation

Actions will run in the order shown below, starting with the action at the top.

☐ Extract fields

Use regular expressions to extract data from a selected field and add it to your ServiceNow alerts. [Learn more.](#)

☒ Copy or compose fields

Copy or combine fields and text to populate an alert field. [Learn more.](#)

Composition ⓘ

→ ☒ Set as a tag ⓘ

Composition ⓘ

→

+ Add fields

☐ Change alert values

Change values of a field to a format that is easier to read, filter and group. [Learn more.](#)

☐ Improve configuration item (CI) identification

Identify CIs other than a host for better alert grouping, team assignment, and service health. [Learn more.](#)

Example source events ⓘ [Test CI identification](#)

Preview 1 of 1 recent events ← →

Standard events fields

Time of event	2025-07-10 03:22:54
Description	CRUPRGWMIDCAV15:Free swap spac...
Severity	Critical
Metric Name	Free swap space in %
Node	10.197.162.56
Resource	Zabbix
Source	108743
Message key	High swap space usage
Type	

Additional info

u_eventid	31385766
u_event_objectid	108743
u_item_id	278826
u_item_key	system.swap.pfree
u_event_name	CRUPRGWMIDCAV15
u_event_clock	1752141305
u_trigger_triggerid	108743
u_trigger_express...	max(/CRUPRGWMIDCAV15/system.swap...
u_item_name	Free swap space in %
u_item_interfaceid	0
u_trigger_descript...	High swap space usage
u_event_source	0
u_hostid	12068

Example: Composing alert fields

Suppose you want to have two input fields that compose data and display it in two different alert output field. In one scenario, you want the source value to come from an existing alert field along with a new field, showing the composed value in a new alert output field. You also plan to tag the new alert output field for later use in tag-based grouping. In the other scenario, you

combine existing fields with free text and select the alert output to display in an existing alert field. Here's how you can achieve this:

- Scenario 1:

1. Source input field: Select an existing alert field and add the text "and", followed by entering another field `u_eventid`. For example: `${classification}` and `${u_eventid}`.

Note that alert fields are displayed in the `${field}` syntax format. You can also select the field name from the drop-down list, and the syntax will be added automatically.

2. Alert output: Enter the name of the new alert field where you want to display the values from the input fields. For example, let's name it `mynewfield`.

Set `mynewfield` as a tag for later use in tag-based grouping. Notice the tag displayed before the field name.

- Scenario 2:

1. Source input field: Select existing alert fields and include any desired free text for how you want them to appear in the alert output field. For example: Problem type: `${type}` with severity `${severity}`.

Alert fields are displayed in the `${field}` syntax format. You can also select the field name from the drop-down box, and the syntax will be added automatically.

2. Alert output: Select an existing alert field where you want to display the values from the input fields. For instance, select Description.